

Google Photos/Google Drive, or Microsoft OneDrive. This is especially more convenient if you have access to good internet speeds.



Cloud storage services allow you to access your backup from multiple devices

Step 2: Check if you have the installation disk for your original OS

Should anything go wrong during the installation process, you also have the option of reinstalling your original OS. If you purchased a retail copy of Windows, your best option is to use the DVD for the reinstall, just make sure you also have the product key. This can be found on a slip inside the box packaging or on the DVD itself. You can also use a tool like Belarc Advisor or Magical Jelly Bean Keyfinder to extract your Windows product key on the system it is installed in. Further, if you have misplaced your installation disk (or do not have one), you can download a Windows ISO from Microsoft's website (yes, even Windows XP) and burn this on a DVD or USB. (Sidenote: For direct download links for Windows 7 ISOs go here: <http://goo.gl/vG2l8Z>). The steps to reinstall your OS using the bootable DVD/USB are similar to those outlined later in the chapter for doing a clean install of Windows.

Step 3: Create a USB recovery (Optional but recommended)

There's always the possibility that you are not extremely happy with the whole overhauled experience of Window 10 and now want to go back to your old operating system. While you can always reinstall your original OS using the installation disk or bootable DVD/USB outlined in Step 2, Windows 7 and 8.1 users have a more convenient option: creating a recovery disk for your OS on an external drive – either a USB hard drive, DVD or network drive.

To do this, first ensure your destination drive (for the backup) is larger than the space used in the primary drive. The more programs/data you have in your primary drive, the more the time required for the backup and